

ALX Foundations: Milestone 3 Worksheet

Instructions: Provide responses to all items in the orange boxes. The worksheet consists of Sections A-E. Work on this worksheet one section at a time throughout your week, and return to Canvas after each section for the next set of content and further instructions.

SECTION A: Problem Statement

Step 1: Your GCGO

Which Grand Challenge or Great Opportunity (GCGO) do you want to play a part in addressing? (Pick one.)

As a reminder, the GCGOs are:

- Urbanisation
- Education
- Infrastructure
- Healthcare
- Climate change
- Governance
- Job creation
- Agriculture
- Natural resources
- Arts, culture, and design
- Tourism
- Empowerment of women
- Regional integration
- Wildlife conservation

GCGO:
Youth unemployment

Step 2: Describe Your Problem

You are going to take a first pass at briefly describing your chosen problem. This can be any problem that speaks to you, as long as it is a real-life occurrence that is clearly linked to your chosen GCGO, that occurs in a certain place and for certain people (and/or animals), and that it can be clearly defined.

For example, if you chose wildlife conservation as your GCGO, you might first state your chosen problem as:

There are very few white rhinos left in Kenya and they are in danger of going extinct.

Another example, if you choose infrastructure as your GCGO:

Residents of major cities in South Africa endure prolonged periods without electricity, significantly hampering their ability to generate income.

Note that this is just your first attempt stating the problem, and you don't need to quantify the problem yet. In order to get to your official problem statement (which does need to be quantifiable) first answer the following questions. The more specific your answers, the better. You may also ask Google, Wikipedia, , ChatGPT, and/or other reliable online sources to help you. Please be sure to cite (give credit to) any sources that you use.

Describe your problem using What/Who/When/Where/Why/How....

1. **What** is the problem? What is reality like because of this problem? What will reality be like if the problem continues?

The increase in the unemployment rate among Kenyan youth.

There is a large number of kenyan people living in poverty. According to google 17% of kenyans(8.9 million) live below the 1.90 u.s dollars per day.

If the problem continues there is going to be a definite increase in the number of people living in poverty, the kenyan economy will decline and the crime rate will reach unsalvageable heights.

2. **Who** does this problem impact, directly and indirectly? Who contributes to the problem?

The impact is directly on the youth. The society is also impacted by this in different ways such as a high crime rate and poor living conditions.

Some of the main contributors to this are the government, financial institutions and educators

3. **When** did this problem begin? When does it occur?

Youth unemployment have been going up over the years and in this study I will be focusing on the trend/ the rate of unemployment among Kenyan youth since 1991-2023

4. **Where** is this problem occurring? What is the context in which it occurs?

This is a problem occurring in Kenya and especially the labour market.

5. **Why** is this a problem? What are the pain points or gaps? Why do you personally care about this problem?

It's a problem that is causative. It's a contributor to many societal ills such as crime and poverty.

Many people would be able to have better lives and poverty would be eradicated if this problem would be solved.

This is important to me because I have experienced the consequences of unemployment as I have lived in conditions where it is hard to make ends meet despite the level of education.

6. **How** would reality be different if this problem were solved? (This can be your opinion.)

There would be no poverty in Kenya as living standards would be high due to an increase in the number of people getting a steady income.

Crimes would significantly reduce and the mental health state of the youth would be much better.

Step 3: Understand and Quantify Your Problem

Next, you will conduct some basic web research to better understand, define, and quantify your problem. You will do this through a combination of Google search, Wikipedia, credible web sources, ChatGPT or other AI research tool, and your own synthesis of information from these sources. Be sure to give credit to your sources, and paraphrase (use your own words) rather than quoting directly.

7. What is the historical context for this problem? What happened in the past that contributes to the problem now?

The rate of unemployment among Kenyan youth has been increasing since the year 1991 with minor decreases in a year like 2009.

Business Daily puts forth that in 2020 730,000 jobs were lost, the youth being the most affected by this loss. In the same year 595,164 gave up on employment.

As of last year 13.35% of the youth are unemployed according to macrotrends.

The surge in the population of employable youths and a slow economic growth being the main reason there is this trend.

8. What are the possible economic (money-related) reasons why this problem exists and continues?

There is a slow or even a declining economic growth all the while the population increasing and the labour market being unable to accommodate new people.

Existing jobs seem to be filled with no other being created causing this strain

lpl.org says that there is a lack of funding/unavailability of capital that could be instrumental in getting the youth the headstart they need in creating their own jobs.

9. What are the possible political reasons why this problem exists and continues?

Poor or a total lack of policies to address this. Policy makers seem to have forgotten this issue or they get nowhere in terms of being able to come up with a solution to this problem.

Corruption. This has been a long time problem for kenyans. Dergipark.org.tr says that as of 2015 of all the corruption cases presented in courts across the country 20% are related to bribery.

Here there's employment of the unemployables the youth in this case being sidelined and missing out on many employment opportunities.

10. What cultural beliefs and/or social norms possibly contribute to this problem?

A study by a student at Zanzibar University shows that a number of employable young people have missed out on opportunities due to a bias against the religion they subscribe to. It has also been noticed that there is favouring certain tribes in some jobs.

11. Who are the people potentially responsible (directly or indirectly) for creating and/or maintaining this problem?

The government is the main culprit. It is responsible for coming up with policies to address this problem and has been so inadequate in doing so.

Financial institutions are also to blame mainly for coming up with a lot of bottlenecks in terms of providing capital and/or funding to youth.

The education system has also in many ways not been able to deliver what the job market has required. Many of the times delivering young people with no skills to match the dynamic labour market.

Now that you have the preliminary information you need, you'll continue your web research to find some numbers, or quantifiable information, to help describe your problem:

What numerical data can you find that is relevant to your problem? Be sure to use your own words and also cite (give credit to) your sources.

Example 1:

According to Chat GPT, there are about 880 white rhinos currently living in Kenya. This population is very small, and they are critically endangered.

Example 2:

Johannesburg has approximately 5.8 million residents (per ChatGPT) and had approximately 4.7 million international overnight visitors in 2019 (according to the South African Tourism Annual Report for 2019/2020).

12. Approximately how many people (and/or animals) are **directly** impacted by this problem? Explain.

As of 2022, 13.35% Kenyan youth are unemployed according to the Kenya Bureau of Statistics (KNBS). This is a very large number considering this number is expected to rise if this problem is left unsolved.

13. Approximately how many people (and/or animals) are **indirectly** impacted by this problem? Explain.

The whole of the Kenyan population. Unemployment affects the society as a whole, its consequences are far reaching, the crime rates will continue spiking, poverty levels will certainly increase, drug abuse, death among other ills

14. What other numerical data can you share that is relevant to your problem? What can you find out about its size and scope? What can be measured? (For example, the amount of trash produced in Nairobi each day, the number of people without access to clean water, etc.)

According to a study in repository.uonbi.ac.ke unemployed youth tend to commit crime at a frequency of 69.62 compared to those in active employment whose frequency is 7.496.

Step 4: Describe Your Solved State

Without having to come up with *how* to solve the problem, describe what the desired, solved state looks like. Please use numbers wherever possible, and make your solved state specific and measurable.

Example 1:

There would be a population of 10,000 healthy and protected white rhinos living in the wild in Kenya.

Example 2:

All 5.8 million residents of Johannesburg would have affordable and consistently available power from clean energy sources, 99.5% of the time.

15. If the problem were addressed/solved, what would reality be like?

Better living conditions for Kenyans, ideally, total eradication of poverty.

A significant decrease in crime rates.

16. Are there other benefits that would come from your problem being solved? Name at least one.

Mental wellness of all kenyans.

More taxes hence economic and development improvement

Kenya would no longer be a third world country(just to be ambitious)

Step 5: Clarify Your Problem Scope

You are more effective at solving a problem when you know where its limits are. That is, when you know what is “in scope” and “out of scope.” For this reason, it is important to list what is out of scope, or NOT included as part of your problem definition.

Example 1:

The scope of the problem does not cover any other animal species besides white rhinos. It does not include white rhinos outside of Kenya.

Example 2:

The scope of the problem does not include any businesses or people outside of the legally-defined Johannesburg city limits. It does not apply to tourists or visitors staying for less than 1 year in Johannesburg.

17. What is NOT in scope for your problem?

The scope of the problem does not include unemployed people over 35 years of age.

Step 6: Areas for Learning

What do you not know or understand that you would like to know more about? This can be anything related directly or indirectly to your problem. Let your curiosity run wild!

Example 1:

I'd like to know where most of the demand for rhino horn is coming from. I'd like to know who are the primary buyers and who is behind the trafficking of rhino horn. I'd like to know how long the average rhino's lifespan is. I'd like to know how many babies a typical female rhino has, and how many babies typically survive into adulthood. I'd like to know more about what diseases impact rhinos. I'd like to know more about the kinds of habitats that rhinos thrive in. I'd like to understand what international organisations do the best job supporting wildlife conservation and what their practices are. I'd like to know what models of community involvement have been most successful in keeping wildlife safe and thriving. I'd like to understand how much land is available in Kenya for rhinos to roam.

Example 2:

I'd like to better understand the utility company Eskom and its history. I'd like to understand why Eskom has failed to plan properly to update its infrastructure. I'd like to understand the relationship between Eskom and the South African government. I'd like to know if there are private

utility companies providing competition to Eksom. I'd like to know what the latest breakthroughs are in solar power. I'd like to know what other possible energy sources might be made available in Johannesburg. I'd like to know how much energy tourists and temporary visitors use. I'd like to better understand the process of how limited energy supply gets allocated to people and businesses. I'd like to better understand the economic impact to people and businesses of not having power.

18. What else would you like to know or understand better? (It can be anything related to your problem.) List 5-10 things.

I'd like to get a better understanding of the ways, if any, this problem has been addressed specifically by policy makers. I'd also like to know how the education system has been designed to better understand why it is failing the youth in terms of employability. I'd like to know the tech skills that are so in demand and why they are so in demand. What has happened to those previously employed without these tech skills? Have they been fired, is there any training that has to bring them up to speed with these changes. I'd like to have a better understanding of what has been done to get people up to speed with the many changes happening in the job market.

Step 7: Problem Statement

This step is the culmination of all you have done in Part A. You will synthesise the work you have done above to create a problem statement of 150 - 250 words. This should be in narrative form, 2-4 paragraphs, and should NOT use bullet points.

Your problem statement should:

- Provide a succinct description of the problem **in the first sentence**.
- Indicate specific population affected
- Explain the impact (cost, time, environmental, personal) and why the problem matters.
- Explain what reality would look like if the problem were solved. The gap that exists between present reality and the desired outcome should be clear.

Please cite (give credit to) where your information came from directly in your statement. Avoid word-for-word quoting and instead paraphrase (use your own words), as modelled in the example. Also list your sources and their urls (web addresses) at the end.

Example :

Kenya's white rhinos are in critical danger of extinction. There are currently about 880 white rhinos in the country of Kenya, per Wikipedia. According to Chat GPT, Rhinos are considered a keystone species, meaning they have a disproportionately large impact on their ecosystem compared to their population size. Rhinos help shape their environment by influencing vegetation growth and acting as seed dispersers, which creates habitat for other species (per ChatGPT).

The extinction of white rhinos would have cascading effects on other plant and animal species in their habitat. According to the Kenya Wildlife Service, rhinos' presence in reserves and parks bring millions of tourists each year, contributing to local economies and supporting conservation efforts. Once a species goes extinct, it is gone forever. The extinction of rhinos would represent the loss of millions of years of evolutionary history, and unique genetic diversity that science has yet to fully understand and benefit from (per ChatGPT).

My problem would be considered solved when the population of wild, white rhinos in Kenya reaches 10,000, and when all imminent threats to their population including poaching and habitat destruction are not present. If this were the reality, it would create ecosystem balance, create large revenues from ecotourism, preserve important cultural symbols, and allow for genetic diversity that could benefit humanity in ways we may not yet fully understand.

Sources:

*Kenya Wildlife Services Annual Report 2017, <https://www.kws.go.ke/content/annual-reports>
ChatGPT, <https://chat.openai.com/>
"White Rhinoceros", Wikipedia, https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/White_rhinoceros*

19. My problem is statement is:

There has been a rise in the rate of unemployment among the youth. According to the Kenya bureau of statistics (KNBS), 13.35% of Kenyan youth are unemployed. The trend from 1991-2023 showing a constant rise from 3.12% to 5.74%. The COVID-19 pandemic worsened the situation as many people lost their jobs, young people being the most affected.

According to a study in erepository.uonbi.ac.ke, unemployed tend to get involved in crime at a frequency of 69.62 compared to those in active employment whose frequency to commit a crime is at 7.496. This shows that youth unemployment plays a great role in contributing to the rise in crimes in the country leading to an unsafe environment for any citizen. There is an association between slow economic growth and unemployment. Poor living conditions are being experienced by millions of Kenyans as a result of not being able to get a secure source of income. Mental health cases have been on the rise among the youth also attributable to unemployment.

A decrease in this rate would mean a stable source of income for the youth and many households in Kenya. Betterment of standards of living and ideally eradication of poverty in Kenya. Kenya's economy would significantly improve which would mean more government revenue and hence more development projects. Crime rates would go down creating safe communities across the country. Mental health cases would decrease reducing the number of deaths attributed to suicides in the country.

20. Please list all sources that you used to form your problem statement

Peacechild.org

www.businessdailyafrica.com

Www.knbs.or.ke

www.worldbank.org



Please go back to Canvas and continue with your learning content. You will be prompted on when to return to complete Section B.

SECTION B: Research Questions & Hypothesis

IMPORTANT: Complete this section AFTER completing the Canvas Modules *Asking Effective Questions* and *Web Research*.

Step 8: Research Questions

Based on what you have learned so far and on 'Step 6: Areas for Learning' from this worksheet, come up with 3 research questions. **Research questions should be complex enough that they can't be answered by a single Google search.** If appropriate, form a hypothesis that your research may confirm or reject. (As a reminder, a hypothesis is a prediction of how you think your research will answer your research question. It is your best guess. If you truly have absolutely no idea, state "not applicable.")

Example Research Question #1:

What are some ways can we increase rhino populations?

Hypothesis:

Rhino populations will be increased by creating more open spaces for them to roam, increasing their protection, increasing international interest in them, and other reasons I have yet to uncover.

Example Research Question #2:

Which organisations have been effective at wildlife conservation and what practices do they use?

Hypothesis:

Not applicable; I don't know.

Example Research Question #3:

How many babies can a typical female white rhino have in her lifetime, and what are the reasons a female may not have high fertility?

Hypothesis:

A typical female white rhino can have 5 babies in her lifetime, and fertility may be affected by diet, amount of grazing territory, poaching, stress, mate availability, and other reasons I have yet to uncover.

21. Research question #1:

What are the causes of the increase in the unemployment rate among the youth in Kenya?

Hypothesis (if applicable):

Not Applicable; I don't know

22. Research question #2:

What are the remedies to this the increase in the rate of unemployment among the youth?

Hypothesis (if applicable):

Not Applicable; I don't know

23. Research question #3

What are some of the organisations involved in changing this status quo?

Hypothesis (if applicable):

Not Applicable; I don't know



Please go back to Canvas and continue with your learning content. You will be prompted on when to return to complete Section C.

PART C: Mini-Research Report

IMPORTANT: Complete this section AFTER completing the Canvas Module *Web Research Executive Summary*.

In 200-300 words, provide an executive summary of your research. You should be synthesising information from multiple sources. Provide answers and explanations for the 3 questions you investigated and your key research findings. This should be in a narrative format (no bullet points), and be at least 3 paragraphs long.

Please use at least 3 different online sources such as ChatGPT, organisational websites, wikipedia, etc.. Please cite (give credit to) where your information came from directly in your statement. Avoid word-for-word quoting and instead paraphrase (use your own words), as modelled in the example. Also list your sources and their urls (web addresses) at the end.

Example Executive Summary:

According to ChatGPT, increasing rhino populations requires multiple approaches. These approaches include: anti-poaching measures; habitat protection and management; translocation and reintroduction; captive breeding and reintroduction; international cooperation between governments, conservation organisations, and communities; community engagement and education; and demand reduction.

According to ChatGPT, the following organisations are well known for wildlife conservation and protection: World Wildlife Fund (WWF), International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), Wildlife Conservation Society (WCS), African Wildlife Foundation (AWF), Pathera, Conservation International, and The Jane Goodall Institute. These organisations engage in different practices to help wildlife. As one example, the World Wildlife Fund, according to their webpage, engages in protecting land where animals roam, educating communities on the importance of protecting wildlife, and shutting down markets in Asia where ivory is sold.

Another example is the African Wildlife Foundation. According to their website, they focus their efforts on conservation education, anti-poaching efforts, habitat restoration, and policy advocacy. The Jane Goodall Institute is a final example. According to their website, they focus on environmental education, and promoting sustainable livelihoods through conservation efforts. There appears to be several ways that reputable wildlife conservation organisations go about accomplishing their goal.

According to the International Rhino Foundation, a typical rhino pregnancy lasts around 16 months. According to the Maryland Zoo, Female white rhinos are able to start producing offspring when they are about 6 years old. A female rhino can give birth to one calf about once every 2-3 years. According to ChatGPT, a female rhino could give birth to as many as 14 offspring in her lifetime, but this is uncommon. Usually, conditions do not support this.

Sources:

African Wildlife Foundation, <https://www.awf.org/strategic-vision-2020-2030>

ChatGPT, <https://chat.openai.com/>

Jane Goodall Institute, <https://janegoodall.org/our-impact/>

International Rhino Foundation <https://rhinos.org/blog/rhino-moms/>

Maryland Zoo, <https://www.marylandzoo.org/animal/southern-white-rhinoceros/>

World Wildlife Fund, <https://www.worldwildlife.org/initiatives/wildlife-conservation>

24. Executive Summary:

According to ChatGPT there are several factors contributing to the increase in the rate of unemployment in Kenya among them being the lack of education and skills needed to secure jobs in the formal sector narrowing the number of employment opportunities for young people in Kenya to the informal sector where the situation is not favourable either. Kenya's economic growth rate is slower than expected leading to limited job opportunities and a lack of some jobs entirely. Corruption has been a major challenge to our country, in many ways crippling many institutions and sectors without sparing the labour market. With recruitment processes being plagued with this deadly practice, employment opportunities remain limited as jobs are gotten through 'connections' and not merit. The discrimination against women is also a major

cause as it takes their chance to advance their careers or even have a job in the first place. There are many bottlenecks in the way financial institutions, credit facilities and government funds offer capital. This makes young people with a mind to be self-employed become discouraged and therefore jobless. Lastly there's a great need to grow careers and professions caused by the lack of mentorship. Young people stay stuck with outdated skills therefore losing their jobs.

The world's population now is majorly comprised of young people as provided by the TVET Journal. 73.4 million of them are unemployed while 53% of the employed are at risk of losing their jobs according to statistics by the international labour organisation (ILO). This only goes to show that this is not a problem for Kenya or Africa but for the whole world and there's an urgent call to come up with solutions. There are a number of remedies to this problem (according to the TVET Journal). The youth need to be equipped with industry-relevant and employer-linked skills rather than the traditional outdated courses full of generalisations in the way they are delivered. Young people need to also be equipped with entrepreneurial skills and encouraged to have a creative mindset to be able to create themselves opportunities and become successful business owners. They need to understand they also can employ themselves. Educators need to emphasise on apprenticeship so that young people can get to appreciate and know the value to college and university. Peacechild.org also suggests a removal of the bottlenecks in the funds are acquired to make capital available to young people to start their own enterprises. This coupled with the government creating effective funds and giving grants as capital will go a long way in solving this problem. The TVET system also needs to promote programs in rural areas to help the youth there get into the career ladder system and avail themselves better employment.

ALX is one of the organisations being so instrumental and proactive in solving this problem. Their commitment in changing the status quo with their mission to develop 3 million ethical and entrepreneurial not only in Kenya but Africa at large will go a long way in overturning these shocking rates. In partnership with The Mastercard Foundation (another organisation bringing change in Africa and helping solve youth unemployment) ALX is seeking to place 2 million young Africans in dignified and fulfilling and dignified work. The Technical and Vocational Training (TVET) is working to equip young people with the right skills to be able to cope in this overpopulated labour market. The Government has also come up with funds namely hustler and uwezo though it could do better.

25. Please list all sources that you used to form your executive summary:

The TVET Journal. <https://tvetjournal>

International Labour organisation, www.ilo.org

ChatGPT, <https://chat.openai.com>

Peacechild.org

World bank, <https://worldbank.org>



Please go back to Canvas and continue with your learning content. Return to Part D after you have completed your City Hub Activities.

PART D: Hub Activities Report

IMPORTANT: Complete this section AFTER completing the Canvas Lessons “Hub Activity: Problem Statement” and “Hub Activity: Web Research.”

Hub Activity #1: Problem Statement

Please report on your process of getting peer feedback.

26. Who reviewed your problem statement (item #19)? (Give the first and last names of your 2 peers.)

1. Judy Nderitu
2. Philip Ng'atia

27. In brief, what feedback did they give to you?

The feedback included some grammatical error correction, pointing out areas where I need to add more information or do more research and clarifying on areas I could have done better.

28. Was their feedback useful to you? Did it feel kind? Why or why not?

It was very useful and delivered in a very kind way. Made me go back and look at those points I was missing and make the necessary corrections and adjustments.

29. Who did you give feedback to? (Give the first and last names of 2 peers- they may be the same or different peers from above.)

1. Judy Nderitu
2. Cynthia Wachira

30. Do you feel that you gave useful and kind feedback to your peers? Why or why not?

The feedback was useful and kind. I think I tried my best to be as helpful as possible and sensitive on the way I gave the feedback.

Hub Activity #2: Web Research

Please report on your process of getting peer feedback.

31. Who reviewed your executive summary (item #24)? (Give the first and last names of your 2 peers.)

1. Judy Nderitu
2. Philip Ng'anga

32. In brief, what feedback did they give to you?

It was feedback on grammatical errors and on the way I outlined my sources.

33. Was their feedback useful to you? Did it feel kind? Why or why not?

The feedback was so useful. I had a few sentence construction errors that I was able to correct due to this

34. Who did you give feedback to? (Give the first and last names of 2 peers- they may be the same or different peers from above.)

1. Judy Nderitu
2. Philip Ng'anga

35. Do you feel that you gave useful and kind feedback to your peers? Why or why not?

I did my best to be helpful and kind. When feedback is given kindly there is a higher chance of it being taken.



After you updated earlier parts of the worksheet based on your feedback, please go back to Canvas and continue with your learning content. Return to Part E prior to submitting your milestone.

PART E: Daily 3 Challenge Report

Please answer the following questions honestly. There are no wrong answers! This is your opportunity for self-reflection.

36. How many days out of the past 7 did you do 20 minutes of movement?

7

37. How many days out of the past 7 did you write 3 morning pages?

4

38. Overall, how do you feel you are doing on building your Daily 3 habits? Explain.

There is a noticeable difference. The morning pages are especially helpful even in the 4 days I have done them. I feel so light and able to go on with the day plus i get to start my day early compared to before.

39. What is your biggest barrier to staying motivated?

Perfectionism. It tires me to always think I have to do everything perfectly and when I make a little mistake I start to think I can't do anything at all.

40. If you have been practicing at least some movement and/or morning pages:

A) What effect (if any) have you noticed on your mood, focus, and productivity?

The morning pages have helped in unfogging my mind and i can move on with my day with a clear mind

B) What helps you stay motivated?

Being able to finish something I started on my own.

41. If you haven't been practicing any movement and morning pages, what would motivate you to get started?

I have.

Once you have completed this worksheet, export/convert to .pdf, rename it per the instructions, and upload to Canvas as your Milestone 3 Submission. Celebrate a job well done!